

Horne, Hearth, & Home
(805) 680-3636
Ventura, CA

CSLB#1122530

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4735 Rossini Lane #104
Ventura, CA 93003
#1122530

NFPA 211 LEVEL 2 CHIMNEY & FIREPLACE INSPECTION REPORT

Property Information

Tonya Peralta

Property Address: 1213 Cuyama Road, Ojai, California 93023

Inspection Date: June 12, 2026

Inspection Type: Level 2 Real Estate Transaction Inspection

Inspection Standard: NFPA 211 – Standard for Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances

INSPECTION SUMMARY

A Level 2 chimney and fireplace inspection was performed at the above referenced property in accordance with the requirements of NFPA 211. A Level 2 inspection is recommended whenever a property changes ownership, after significant system changes, following operating malfunctions, or when a more comprehensive evaluation of the chimney system is required. This inspection included evaluation of all readily accessible interior and exterior fireplace components, chimney structures, chimney terminations, crowns, flashing systems, fireboxes, dampers, smoke chambers, hearth extensions, and associated venting systems.

The residence contains three masonry fireplaces. Fireplace #1 is located in the Front Studio and is equipped with an older vented gas log set installed within a traditional masonry fireplace. Fireplaces #2 and #3 are located in the Living Room and Dining Room and share a common reinforced masonry chimney structure serving two separate fireplace openings.

Overall, the chimney systems remain serviceable; however, numerous deficiencies were identified. The most significant findings include heavy creosote accumulation within all three chimney systems, deterioration of clay flue liner mortar joints, evidence of ongoing moisture

intrusion, damaged and seized dampers, deteriorated flashing systems, masonry cracking, and deficiencies within the chimney crowns and smoke chambers.

Water intrusion appears to be contributing to several of the observed deficiencies. Evidence of moisture migration was identified through efflorescence, rusted metal components, washed-out mortar joints, and exterior masonry deterioration. Left uncorrected, moisture intrusion can accelerate deterioration of the flue liners, fireboxes, chimney crowns, dampers, and structural masonry components.

While no immediate structural failure was observed, repairs and maintenance are recommended before continued regular operation. Corrective action will improve safety, reduce fire hazards, improve draft performance, and extend the overall service life of the fireplace and chimney systems.

FIREPLACE #1 – FRONT STUDIO





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Detailed Summary

The Front Studio fireplace is a reinforced masonry fireplace measuring approximately 33¾ inches wide, 25½ inches high, and 23 inches deep. The fireplace is equipped with an older 24-inch vented gas log set installed within the original masonry firebox. Although currently configured for gas operation, the fireplace retains its original wood-burning chimney system and should continue to be maintained as a masonry fireplace and chimney assembly.

Inspection revealed several maintenance and repair concerns affecting both safety and long-term durability. The gas connector supplying the appliance is improperly configured and kinked, a void exists where the gas line enters the firebox, the damper is heavily rusted and seized in the open position, and heavy creosote accumulation is present throughout the venting system. Internal inspection also revealed deterioration of the clay flue liner mortar joints and defects within the smoke chamber area.

Moisture intrusion is a significant concern for this fireplace. The chimney crown exhibits visible cracking and deterioration, while the roof flashing surrounding the chimney is in poor condition. These deficiencies have likely contributed to the rusting of internal components and deterioration of the venting system. Corrective repairs are recommended to prevent further deterioration and maintain safe operation.

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Component Findings

1. Firebox



The firebox is the combustion chamber designed to safely contain fire and protect surrounding combustible materials from excessive heat exposure. The masonry firebox was found to be structurally stable and generally serviceable. No major structural failures were observed at the time of inspection.

2. Gas Log Set

An older 24-inch vented gas log set is installed within the fireplace. The appliance remains in fair overall condition considering its age. Annual servicing and cleaning are recommended to maintain safe and reliable operation.

3. Gas Connector



The flexible gas connector supplying the appliance was found to be kinked and improperly installed. Damaged gas connectors may restrict fuel flow and can eventually fail. Replacement with a properly sized approved connector is recommended.

4. Gas Line Penetration

A visible void exists where the gas line enters the firebox. Openings around utility penetrations allow heat, smoke, and combustion byproducts to migrate into concealed spaces. The opening should be sealed using a listed high-temperature sealant.

5. Damper Assembly

The damper regulates airflow through the chimney when the fireplace is not in use. The damper was heavily rusted and seized in the open position. Corrosion is likely related to prolonged moisture intrusion. Cleaning may improve operation; however replacement may ultimately be necessary.

6. Smoke Chamber



The smoke chamber transitions combustion gases from the firebox into the flue liner. Voids and irregular surfaces were observed within the smoke chamber and lintel area. These defects create

turbulence, reduce draft efficiency, and allow excessive heat transfer into surrounding masonry. Restoration using SmokeTite is recommended.

7. Creosote Accumulation

Heavy creosote deposits were observed throughout the venting system. Creosote is a combustible byproduct of wood burning and is the leading cause of chimney fires. Professional sweeping is strongly recommended prior to continued operation.



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8. Flue Liner

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The chimney contains approximately 12 feet of 9-inch by 17-inch terra cotta clay flue liner. Internal inspection revealed deterioration and washout of mortar joints between liner sections. Clay liner systems are designed to contain heat, smoke, combustion gases, and creosote within the venting pathway. Deteriorated joints compromise that containment and increase the likelihood of further chimney deterioration. Restoration using the HeatShield Joint Repair System is recommended.

9. Spark Arrestor



A black galvanized spark arrestor is installed at the chimney termination. The spark arrestor was present and functional at the time of inspection.

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10. Chimney Crown



The crown exhibits visible cracking and deterioration. The crown serves as the primary defense against water intrusion. Continued deterioration will accelerate masonry damage and liner deterioration.

11. Flashing System



The flashing surrounding the chimney is in very poor condition. Flashing provides the waterproof transition between the chimney and roof system. Deteriorated flashing is a common source of water intrusion and should be corrected by a qualified roofing contractor.

12. Exterior Masonry Structure

The reinforced masonry chimney remains generally stable. Weathering and moisture exposure were observed. Exterior waterproofing and masonry restoration should be considered to improve long-term durability.

Estimated Cost of Repairs – Fireplace #1

Replace Gas Connector: $85

Seal Gas Line Penetration: $20

Smoke Chamber Restoration (SmokeTite): $250

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Professional Chimney Sweeping: $250

HeatShield Joint Repair System: $650

Crown Seal Treatment: $300

Optional Crown Replacement: $1,250

Roof Flashing Repairs: By Qualified Roofing Contractor

FIREPLACE #2 – LIVING ROOM



Summary

The Living Room fireplace is a reinforced masonry fireplace measuring approximately 41¾ inches wide, 32 inches high, and 20 inches deep. This fireplace shares a common reinforced masonry chimney structure with Fireplace #3 located in the Dining Room. The fireplace is equipped with a gas log lighter designed to assist with ignition of wood-burning fires.

The fireplace exhibits significant creosote accumulation and evidence of long-term moisture intrusion. Interior inspection revealed deterioration of the clay flue liner mortar joints, minor cracking within the firebox, a rusted damper assembly, and water-related staining and efflorescence. The chimney structure itself exhibits visible cracking and weather-related deterioration.

One of the more significant deficiencies is the absence of a functional chimney crown. Without a proper crown, water is allowed to enter the chimney structure, accelerating deterioration of masonry components, flue liners, dampers, and mortar joints. Repair of these deficiencies is recommended to improve safety and extend the service life of the chimney system.

Component Findings

1. Firebox

Minor cracking was observed on the rear wall of the firebox. The cracking appears consistent with thermal expansion and contraction commonly found in older masonry fireplaces. Monitoring and future repairs may be required if deterioration progresses.

2. Hearth Extension and Surround

The hearth extension and fireplace surround meet or exceed current clearance requirements and are in satisfactory condition.

3. Gas Log Lighter

A gas log lighter is installed within the fireplace to assist with the ignition of wood-burning fires. Log light placement is too far forward. The valve is located to the left side of the fireplace and was present during inspection.

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4. Damper Assembly



The damper was found rusted and seized. Cleaning may improve operation, although replacement may eventually be required.

5. Smoke Chamber and Throat



The smoke chamber and throat area were found in generally satisfactory condition with no major defects noted.

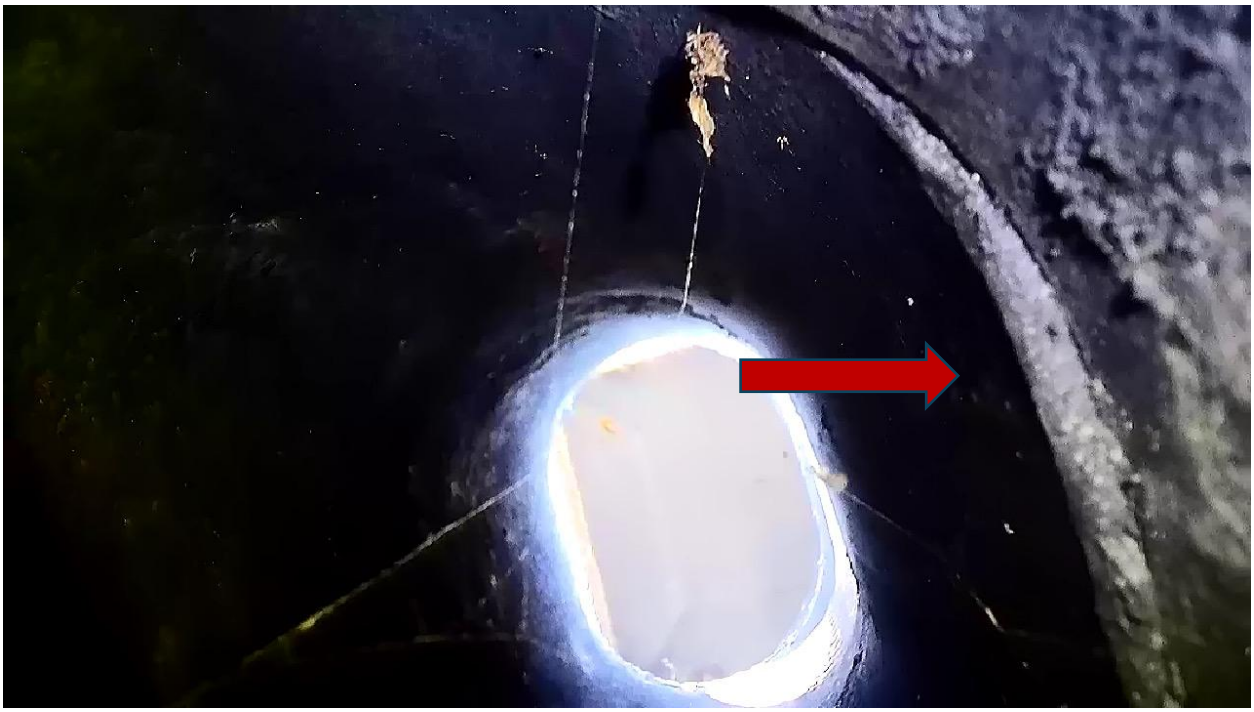
6. Creosote Accumulation

Heavy creosote accumulation was observed throughout the chimney system. Cleaning is recommended prior to further operation.

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7. Flue Liner System



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The chimney contains 9-inch by 17-inch terra cotta clay flue liners. Internal inspection revealed significant deterioration and washout of mortar joints. Restoration using the HeatShield Joint Repair System is recommended.

8. Spark Screens



The spark screens are damaged and nearing the end of their useful life. Replacement is recommended to improve fireplace safety.

9. Moisture Intrusion

Efflorescence and water staining were observed within the firebox. These conditions indicate ongoing moisture migration through the chimney structure.

10. Exterior Masonry Structure

The reinforced masonry chimney exhibits visible cracking and weather-related deterioration. Repairs through grout restoration or exterior plastering are recommended.

11. Chimney Crown



No functional crown is present. Installation of a properly constructed chimney crown is strongly recommended.

12. Chimney Termination

The chimney is equipped with a double-flue spark arrestor which was present and serviceable at the time of inspection.

Estimated Cost of Repairs – Fireplace #2

Professional Chimney Sweeping: $250

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Replace Spark Screens: $200

HeatShield Joint Repair System: $1,850

Masonry Crack Repairs and Grouting: $250

Optional Exterior Chimney Plaster Restoration: $1,200

Install New Chimney Crown: $1,850

FIREPLACE #3 – DINING ROOM



Summary

The Dining Room fireplace measures approximately 36 inches wide, 32 inches high, and 19½ inches deep. This fireplace shares the reinforced masonry chimney structure with the Living Room fireplace and utilizes a separate clay liner system within the common chimney assembly.

Inspection identified heavy creosote accumulation, deterioration of flue mortar joints, moisture intrusion, rusted damper components, and deficiencies related to the gas log lighter installation. Efflorescence observed within the firebox indicates long-term water migration through the masonry structure. The roof flashing serving the shared chimney system was also found in poor condition.

While the fireplace remains structurally serviceable, corrective maintenance is recommended to restore proper operation and prevent continued deterioration.

Component Findings

1. Firebox



The masonry firebox remains suitable for wood-burning operation. No major structural deficiencies were observed.

2. Hearth Extension and Surround

The hearth extension and surrounding clearances meet or exceed minimum safety requirements and were found satisfactory.

3. Gas Log Lighter



The fireplace contains a gas log lighter designed to assist with wood fire ignition. The lighter is installed too far forward within the firebox. Relocation toward the center of the firebox is recommended to improve performance and safety.

4. Damper Assembly



The damper is heavily rusted and difficult to operate. Cleaning may improve functionality, although replacement may eventually become necessary.

5. Creosote Accumulation

Heavy creosote accumulation was observed throughout the venting system. Professional cleaning is recommended.

6. Flue Liner System





The chimney contains 9-inch by 12-inch terra cotta clay flue liners. Significant mortar washout and deterioration were observed between clay liner sections. Restoration using the HeatShield Joint Repair System is recommended.

7. Spark Screens

Spark screens were present and found in fair condition. Continued use is acceptable at this time.

8. Moisture Intrusion

Efflorescence was observed on the rear wall of the firebox. Efflorescence is evidence of moisture migration through masonry materials and indicates ongoing water intrusion.

9. Exterior Chimney Structure

The fireplace shares the reinforced masonry chimney structure with Fireplace #2. Exterior deterioration and weather-related wear were observed.

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10. Flashing System

The roof flashing surrounding the chimney is in poor condition and is likely contributing to moisture intrusion within the chimney structure.

Estimated Cost of Repairs – Fireplace #3

Relocate Gas Log Lighter: $125

Professional Chimney Sweeping: $250

HeatShield Joint Repair System: $1,850

Roof Flashing Repairs: By Qualified Roofing Contractor

PROJECT REPAIR ESTIMATE

Fireplace #1 – Front Studio

Replace Improper Gas Connector: $85

Seal Gas Line Penetration with High Temperature Sealant: $20

Smoke Chamber Restoration and Void Repair Using SmokeTite: $250

Professional Chimney Sweeping and Creosote Removal: $250

HeatShield Flue Joint Restoration System: $650

Crown Seal Waterproofing Treatment: $300

Subtotal Fireplace #1: $1,555

Optional Complete Crown Replacement: Add $950 (difference between crown seal and replacement)

Fireplace #2 – Living Room

Professional Chimney Sweeping and Creosote Removal: $250

Replace Damaged Spark Screens: $200

HeatShield Flue Joint Restoration System: $1,850

Masonry Crack Repair and Grout Restoration: $250

Install New Reinforced Concrete Chimney Crown: $1,850

Subtotal Fireplace #2: $4,400

Fireplace #3 – Dining Room

Relocate Gas Log Lighter to Proper Position: $125

Professional Chimney Sweeping and Creosote Removal: $250

HeatShield Flue Joint Restoration System: $1,850

Subtotal Fireplace #3: $2,225

OVERALL RECOMMENDATIONS

Based upon the findings of this Level 2 inspection, the primary concerns affecting the chimney systems are heavy creosote accumulation, moisture intrusion, deteriorated clay flue liner mortar joints, rusted dampers, deficient chimney crowns, and deteriorated flashing systems.

It is recommended that all three chimney systems be professionally cleaned prior to continued operation and that the identified repairs be completed to reduce fire hazards, improve draft performance, limit water intrusion, and extend the service life of the chimney structures.



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The findings contained within this report are based upon conditions visible and accessible at the time of inspection and are consistent with the procedures outlined within NFPA 211 for a Level 2 chimney inspection.